The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

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Gandy basks half-asleep in the sun while Maevy chases a butterfly clean across the deck.

Skies o'er the Hold 68° / 46° Sunny

A bright, mild day — sunny skies, a steady breeze, and no rain in it.

Wind 8 mph · Feels like 63° · UV 5 (Moderate) · Rain 0%

Sunrise 6:40 AM · Sunset 5:36 PM · Tomorrow — Overcast, 69/47

The Moon's Reckoning

Yesterday · Tonight (Full Moon) · Tomorrow (Waning Gibbous)

waning toward the new moon

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
56° Sunny 5 mph	66° Sunny 8 mph	65° Sunny 6 mph	52° Clear 5 mph

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Halloween Week Fills the Holds, and a New Pub Draws a Crowd

Payson, Ariz.

Listen to this story



Pumpkins take their places on the tables as Halloween week opens across the Holds.

Hail, wayfarer, and good Tirdas morning to you — the sun is up over the Rim, the pines stand bright and still, and Mogollon's Hearth sends warm greetings on a sunny day that tops out at 68 degrees. PAYSON — The big good-news story in the Hold is the new Tonto Apache Pub, on Highway 87 at Mile Marker 251, on the left side of the Mazatzal Hotel and Casino building with its own outside entrance. The Payson Roundup reports it opened to crowds through its opening weekend — folks stopped in Friday, Oct. 9 and came right back Saturday, Oct. 10, rainy weather and all. The pub's own page promises premium craft beers, superior cocktails, gourmet plates, and every screen a window to the game. Beyond the pub, Halloween week is upon us: trail work in Pine today, music in Prescott tonight, and a Saturday full of trunk-or-treats, haunted forts, and costumed fun from Camp Verde to Sedona.

Happening in the Holds Today

Listen to this story

- **Payson**

  — **Payson Public Library day** — Tai Chi at 9 in the morning and Sit and Stitch from 2 to 5 in the afternoon, at the library on North McLane Road. Tai Chi is a gentle way to start a sunny Tirdas, all slow moves and deep breaths under the pines. Sit and Stitch brings the needleworkers together for an afternoon of yarn, talk, and steady progress. Call the library at 928-474-9260 to register. A fine, calm pair of doings for guests who like their days unhurried.

- **Pine-Strawberry**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine** — today from 7 in the morning to noon, off Highway 87 just before Pine. Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to help clear brush, move rocks, and shape a trail the whole community will use for years. The work also opens better access for fire crews, so every hour given does double duty. Bring water, sunscreen, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes — tools are provided and no experience is needed. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions and details.

- **Prescott**

  — **Open Mic hosted by Greystone** — tonight from 5:30 to 8:30 in Prescott. Local singers, pickers, and poets take their turn in the spotlight while the crowd settles in with supper and something warm. Open mics are where a Hold hears itself think out loud — part concert, part town meeting with better tunes. Arrive early if you mean to perform, and stay late for the surprises. A merry way to close a sunny day on the road.

The Days Ahead

Listen to this story

- **Wed, Oct. 28**

  — **Wednesday Music at Back Alley Wine Bar** in Prescott, 5:30 to 8:30 in the evening, with Wednesday karaoke following at 7. Midweek music is a fine excuse for Valley Dwellers to linger one more night under the pines. Expect an easy crowd, local voices, and songs everybody half-knows and fully enjoys. Sing along or simply listen — both are honored customs of the mead hall.

- **Thu, Oct. 29**

  — **Marigold Mural Project** begins at Tlaquepaque in Sedona, running 11 to 5 each day through the weekend on Calle Independencia. Visitors paint a tribute to a loved one on a long community remembrance wall, with murals from earlier years standing nearby for heart and inspiration. Brushes and paints are supplied, so you need only bring a name and a memory. It is one of the gentlest, kindest doings of the whole season.

- **Fri, Oct. 30**

  — **Prescott — The Rough Rider** opens at Courthouse Square in Prescott, a three-day gravel bike race running Oct. 30 through Nov. 1. Riders take on three stages of high-desert roads based in historic downtown, all grit, grind, and glory. Spectators get the best of it — fast starts, dusty finishes, and a square full of food and cheer. Come wave the riders home like bards greeting heroes.

- **Sat, Oct. 31**

  — **Camp Verde Trunk or Treat** takes over Main Street in Camp Verde from 5 to 7 in the evening. Businesses, groups, and neighbors line the street with decorated cars, trucks, and booths, handing out candy to a crowd the town counts in the thousands. There is a decorating contest, haunted houses, games, music, and a haunted jail for the brave. Costumes are very much the order of the night. Bring a bag with room to spare.

  — **A Haunting at the Fort** at Fort Verde State Historic Park, 6 to 8 in the evening. This lantern-lit walk lets you glimpse the old fort after hours, hear ghost stories, and visit with those who still call the fort home after 150 years. There is no extra cost beyond regular park admission. It is spooky in the friendly, storyteller way — perfect after the trunk-or-treat crowds thin.

  — **Uptown Trick or Treat** in Sedona, 5 to 8 in the evening along Uptown's main street. Shops hand out candy as costumed families wander from door to door under the red rocks. It is Sedona's biggest Halloween gathering and a joyful one, all glow and giggles. Come early for parking and stay for the parade of tiny dragons and knights.

  — **Witch Way to the Spring? A Halloween Cleanup** at See Spring Trail in Christopher Creek, 10:30 in the morning to 3:30 in the afternoon. The Women's Wine Hiking Society leads a spooky-season cleanup hike to keep the trail from looking like a graveyard. Costumes are welcome, good deeds are the point, and the spring rewards the walk at the end. A fine way to earn your evening candy.

- **Sun, Nov. 1**

  — **Día de los Muertos at Tlaquepaque** in Sedona, with altars, music, and cultural performances honoring loved ones who have died. The courtyards fill with marigolds, candles, and families remembering together in the open air. It follows the Marigold Mural Project's remembrance wall, so the weekend reads as one long, kind act of memory. Guests who go will come home with full hearts.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torch sconces, and the doors wait their turn on the workshop bench.

- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Print two torches plus the socket test piece, and test-fit the bulb and socket first.
- ☐ **Design and prep the torch sconces** — Scale the sconce model to the flame bulb, slice in PETG, and check the door-light wiring.
- ☐ **Finish and install the torches** — Paint, seal against the sun, wire into the door-light boxes with the breaker off, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Laser-cut layered plywood, 3D-print the troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, where the walkway sees it best.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — The front and side door work that ties the shield and torches together.

All six quests stand ready — the torch sconces and the Hearth shield have waited longest, so the workshop calls their names first.

Merchant of the Hold

Listen to this story

White Mountain Books · *Show Low*



Inside White Mountain Books, where the shelves run deep and the hours run short.

A great vault of pre-owned books in Show Low — thousands of used titles, vinyl records, and DVDs, plus local honey, jewelry, art, and handmade goods from mountain artisans. By a touch of shelf-magic worthy of the Arcanaeum, a Tolkien tale or a vintage prayer book seems to surface just when a traveler asks for it. Their signature treasure is the deep used-book hunt itself: come for one paperback, leave with a stack and a story.

> *"Visitors praise the shop as far bigger than it looks, with a most amazing selection of books and staff who know their shelves well — the kind of place you could happily spend all day in."* — Places reviews for White Mountain Books

1150 E Deuce of Clubs, Show Low. Open Monday to Thursday 10 to 5, Friday and Saturday 10 to 6. Phone 928-532-5533. Prices are inexpensive. Good to know: give yourself time — the aisles reward slow browsing, and the shop also does fingerprinting by appointment. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Every guest hall needs a book for a quiet night by the hearth, and this is the Hold's finest place to find one.

Tales from the Treeline

Listen to this story

The Great Pumpkin-Carving Judgment



Earl judges, Henny enters herself, and every pumpkin wins.

Tirdas dawned sunny and mild, so Mabel (a wood elf) declared a pumpkin-carving contest on the Hearth clearing, and Earl (an elk) appointed himself judge before anyone could object.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) carved his pumpkin with a grin so wide it needed a second pumpkin to finish the smile. Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) helpfully chilled every finished face so the edges stayed crisp, though his zigzag landing knocked one entry gently into the leaf pile. Henny (the Hearth's chicken) entered herself by sitting inside a hollow pumpkin wearing the lid as a hat, and refused all judging on grounds of already winning.

Earl paced the row three times, antlers high, dignity higher. Then he sneezed at a drifting leaf, crowned every pumpkin at once with one nod, and declared a tie. Mabel sighed like it was her job — because it is — and served pie to all hands. That dang ol' Jethro is still telling folks his pumpkin smiled first.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Tirdas be free of spiders, the admin.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com